



Zuckerberg says Hell No!

Facebook has issued an appeal for the fine imposed upon them for the Cambridge Analytica fine in UK <https://digit.in/dec18-126-1>



BFR to now be Starship

Elon Musk has renamed the SpaceX Mars colonising spacecraft yet again. <https://digit.in/dec18-126-2>

A DIGITAL DEMISE

What happens to a digital identity after death?

Arnab Mukherjee | arnab@digit.in

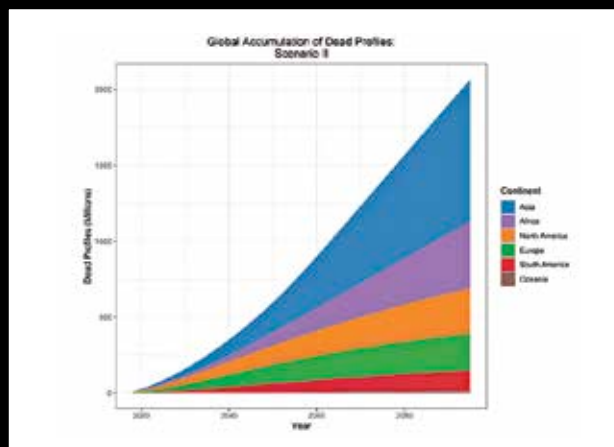
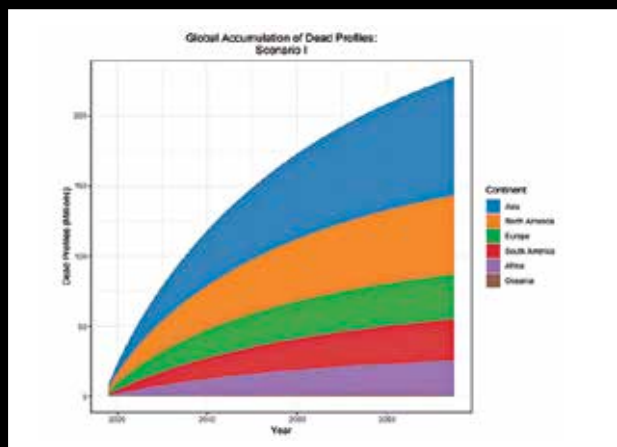
The only thing certain about life is death, or so it was until our lives moved online... While various cultures treat their dead in many different ways, there is a consensus about needing a ritual to bid farewell. This is not something we do online though. While it is ridiculous to have a funeral for a Facebook profile, and that's not we're suggesting... there is the need to identify profiles that belong to the deceased, and each big tech company has a way of dealing with death.

GOING OFFLINE

Various digital platforms provide different methods to deal with the

profiles and accounts of the deceased. Perhaps the most impactful area for this is social media. Facebook, notably the biggest social media platform on the internet, offers a number of ways to go about this. Mainly, a user can choose to memorialise their account or get it deleted altogether. Going to the Settings>General>Manage Account and nominating a friend as a legacy contact gives them access to certain actions like pinning a post, responding to a new friend request or update your profile picture. In the event of the account holder's passing away, someone will have to go to digit.in/FBDEM and point to the profile, the date of passing and if possible, proof of passing away. Doing this informs Facebook that the account needs to be memorialised, or deleted, depending upon the preference picked by the user. A memorialised account appears with 'Remembering' before the username.

Twitter only allows the removal of a deceased person's account through this form: digit.in/TwtrDem. Instagram, like its parent company Facebook, also allows the memorialising of an account. Memorialised accounts on Instagram do not appear any different than a usual account but are effectively frozen in terms of likes, followers etc. Instagram provides a form for this process here: digit.in/InstaDem. While memorialising requires proof of death on Instagram as well, a deletion request also requires you to show that you are authorised to act on the deceased's behalf. Google provides an Inactive Account Manager as well as a form at digit.in/GglDem to close the account of a deceased person, as well as request funds or data from it. Apart from this, most digital platforms require a proof in the form of a link to an obituary or some official record to close a deceased person's account.



The lower and upper bounds for the global accumulation of Facebook profiles belonging to the deceased